

AI LEGAL™

# Law Firm Team & Seat Management System

Roles, RBAC Permissions, Seat Allocation, Member Invites & Lifecycle Governance

| Document Area  | Details                                                                            |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary System | AI LEGAL™ Law Firm Team & Seat Management                                          |
| Core Functions | RBAC, seat allocation, invitations, modular access and member lifecycle governance |
| Primary Users  | Managing Partners, Advocates, Researchers, Paralegals, Clerks, Admin & Accounts    |
| Security Model | Role-Based Access Control + permission levels + module-level access                |

## # AI LEGAL — Law Firm Team & Seat Management System

### ## Roles, RBAC Permissions, Seat Allocation, Member Invites & Lifecycle Governance

#### ## 1. Executive Summary & Purpose

A modern law firm operates as a multi-tiered legal organization where managing partners, senior litigation counsels, junior advocates, researchers, paralegals, and administrative clerks must work together seamlessly. However, legal ethics and client confidentiality require strict `\\Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)\\`: a paralegal reviewing evidentiary annexures should not be able to delete court pleadings, and an intern assisting on case law research should not have access to firm billing ledgers or client fee retainers.

The `\\AI LEGAL Team & Seat Management System\\` provides enterprise-grade governance over:

1. `\\Dynamic Seat Allocation & Plan Limits:\\` Real-time tracking of `\\usedSeats\\` against `\\maxSeats\\`, with seamless in-app upgrade triggers.
2. `\\14 Granular Legal Roles:\\` Reflecting authentic Indian and international court practice hierarchies.
3. `\\5 Tiered Permission Levels:\\` Ranging from `\\View Only\\` to full `\\Administrator\\` rights.
4. `\\12 Modular Feature Toggles:\\` Independent on/off access control for each workspace module.
5. `\\Multi-Channel Smart Invitation Delivery:\\` Automated dispatch via in-app push, verified email, and automated WhatsApp business notifications.
6. `\\Active Lifecycle Governance:\\` Instant status toggles (`\\Active\\` ↔ `\\Pending Invite\\` / `\\Deactivated\\`) and safe member offboarding with case protection.

#### ## 2. Seat Capacity & Licensing Architecture

Every law firm workspace is provisioned with a strict seat quota determined by its active enterprise subscription tier:

`\\mermaid`

```
graph TD
  Firm[Law Firm Workspace] --> Quota{Seat Check: usedSeats >= maxSeats?}
  Quota -- Yes --> Block[Block Invite & Trigger Upgrade Modal]
  Block --> SubModal[Subscription Upgrade Screen / Razorpay Tier Expansion]
  Quota -- No --> Allow[Permit Invite Creation]
  Allow --> Modal[InviteTeamMemberModal.jsx]
  Modal --> API[POST /api/workspaces/:workspaceId/invitations]
  API --> Incr[Add to Pending Roster / usedSeats + 1]
```

`\\`

#### ### 2.1 Seat Calculation Engine

In `\\LawFirmDashboardSection.jsx\\`:

`\\javascript`

`// Dynamic seat calculation matching mobile & web apps`

`const maxSeats = user?.maxSeats || 10;`

`const usedSeats = teamMembers.length;`

`// Invitation guard checking seat ceiling`

`if (usedSeats >= maxSeats) {`

`triggerUpgradeModal({`

`title: 'Firm Seat Limit Reached',`

`message: `Your firm plan currently supports up to ${maxSeats} team members. Upgrade your subscription to invite additional team members.`,`

```

used: usedSeats,
limit: maxSeats,
feature: 'teammembers'
});
return;
}
\\

```

### ## 3. The 14 Professional Legal Roles Hierarchy

The platform defines 14 tailored roles aligned with court practice and law chamber hierarchy:

\\ Role Name | Scope of Responsibility | Typical User in Firm |

\\:---|:---|:---|

\\ \\Managing Partner\\ | Executive leadership, firm oversight, billing, policy governance, and workspace administration. | Senior founding partner / Head of Chambers. |

\\ \\Senior Advocate\\ | Senior counsel leading high-stakes litigation, strategy formulation, and High Court / Supreme Court appearances. | Designated Senior Counsel / Lead Trial Partner. |

\\ \\Partner\\ | Equity or salaried partner managing departmental cases, client relationships, and team leads. | Department Head (e.g. Head of Civil / Corporate). |

\\ \\Associate Advocate\\ | Handles active litigation, client conferences, drafting pleadings, and lower court appearances. | Mid-level practicing lawyer (3–7 years experience). |

\\ \\Junior Advocate\\ | Primary case research, initial draft preparation, registry filings, and routine court mentions. | Junior counsel (1–3 years experience). |

\\ \\Legal Consultant\\ | Subject matter specialist providing specialized legal opinions, advisory memos, and cross-border advice. | External advisory counsel / Tax specialist. |

\\ \\Legal Researcher\\ | Dedicated legal research, landmark judgment collation, SCC/AIR citations, and precedent analysis. | Research associate / LL.M scholar. |

\\ \\Paralegal\\ | Document indexing, case diary maintenance, compliance checklists, and paper book compilation. | Legal assistant / Senior paralegal. |

\\ \\Evidence Clerk\\ | Managing document chain of custody, OCR tagging, exhibit labeling, and physical evidence records. | Evidence custodian / Records manager. |

\\ \\Court Clerk\\ | Managing court filings, caveat searches, registry stamp follow-ups, and daily cause list tracking. | Munshi / Registry clerk. |

\\ \\Legal Intern\\ | Trainee assisting with case summaries, background reading, and court observation. | Law student (3rd/5th year B.A. LL.B). |

\\ \\Admin Staff\\ | Office operations, conference scheduling, travel logistics, and firm correspondence. | Office manager / Executive secretary. |

\\ \\Accounts\\ | Billing, retainer fee invoices, tax invoices (GST), disbursement records, and payment reconciliation. | Firm accountant / Financial controller. |

\\ \\Custom Role\\ | User-defined custom role tailored to specific chamber workflows. | Specialized practice staff. |

### ## 4. The 5 Permission Levels & RBAC Matrix

Each invited member is assigned a fundamental permission level that determines their read, write, and deletion privileges:

\\

[View Only] → [Standard Member] → [Case Editor] → [Manager] → [Administrator]  
 (Lowest Access) (Full Control)

\\

### ### Detailed Permission Matrix

\\ Feature / Action | View Only | Standard Member | Case Editor | Manager | Administrator |

\\:---|:---|:---|:---|:---|:---|

\\ \\View Assigned Case Files\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\View Unassigned Firm Files\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\Draft Pleadings & Petitions\\ | ☐ | ☐ (Draft only) | ☐ (Full edit) | ☐ (Approve) | ☐ (Approve) |

\\ \\Upload Evidentiary Exhibits\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\Assign Cases to Associates\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\Approve Junior Drafts\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\Invite / Deactivate Members\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\Modify Workspace Billing\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

\\ \\Delete Firm Cases & Dockets\\ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ (With confirmation) |

### ## 5. Granular 12-Module Access Control

In addition to role and permission level, the Managing Partner can explicitly enable or disable access to any of the 12 workspace modules on a per-member basis:

\\javascript

// ALLMODULES from InviteTeamMemberModal.jsx

const ALLMODULES = [

'Firm Dashboard', // Overview metrics and team activity

'Cases', // Case dockets, client files, and cause lists

'Documents', // Cloud repository, court orders, petitions

'Evidence', // Evidence Analyst, OCR exhibits, chain of custody

'Tasks', // Associate task assignments and deadlines

'Hearings', // Court appearances and daily cause list alerts

'Calendar', // Firm-wide synchronized court calendar

'Research', // AI Legal Precedent Finder & Search

'AI Assistant', // GenAI drafting, strategy, and citation queries

'Reports', // Performance, caseload, and audit reports

'Billing', // Fee retainers, invoices, and expense claims

'Client CRM' // Client directory, consultations, and messaging

];

\\

\\Example:\\ A \\Legal Researcher\\ can be given access exclusively to \\Research\\ and \\AI Assistant\\, while having \\Billing\\, \\Client CRM\\, and \\Evidence\\ hidden from their dashboard.

### ## 6. The \\InviteTeamMemberModal\\ Walkthrough

The \\InviteTeamMemberModal\\ component (\\src/Tools/AI Legal/components/InviteTeamMemberModal.jsx) provides a step-by-step form for inviting team members:

### ### 6.1 Section 1: Member Information

- \Full Name (Required):\ e.g., \"Adv. Amit Kumar\"
- \Email Address (Required/Optional):\ Used for instant email delivery.
- \Mobile Number (Required/Optional):\ Used for WhatsApp business onboarding link.
- \Bar Council Registration No.:\ (e.g., \D/1234/2020).
- \State Bar Council:\ Dropdown (Delhi, Maharashtra & Goa, UP, Karnataka, etc.).

### ### 6.2 Section 2: Role & Department

- Select from the 14 professional roles. Real-time description cards explain the scope of the chosen role.
- Department selection: \Civil Litigation\, \Criminal Litigation\, \Corporate Law\, \Family Law\, \Taxation\, \Labour Law\, \Property Law\, \IPR\, \Arbitration\, etc.

### ### 6.3 Section 3: Permission Level & Modular Access

- Choose one of the 5 permission levels (\View Only\ to \Administrator).
- Checkbox grid toggling individual access for the 12 modules.

### ### 6.4 Section 4: Smart Delivery Routing

The system dispatches invitations through three synchronized channels:

1. \In-App Direct Notification:\ If the invitee already has an AI LEGAL account with matching email/phone, the invitation appears directly in their pending invitations drawer.
2. \Branded Email Invitation:\ Contains a one-click magic link, workspace details, and step-by-step onboarding instructions.
3. \WhatsApp Smart Routing:\ Dispatches an automated onboarding message with the invitation link directly to the lawyer's WhatsApp if enabled.

### ### 6.5 Form Submission Code Snippet

```
\\javascript
const payload = {
  fullName: fullName.trim(),
  email: email.trim(),
  mobile: mobile.trim(),
  barCouncilNo: barCouncilNo.trim(),
  stateBarCouncil,
  role,
  department,
  permission,
  modules: selectedModules,
  personalMessage: personalMessage.trim()
};
const res = await apiService.post(/workspaces/${activeWsId}/invitations\, payload);
if (res?.data?.success) {
  toast.success(\ Invitation successfully sent to ${fullName}!);
  onSuccess(res.data.invitation);
  onClose();
}
```

\\

## ## 7. Member Lifecycle & Status Governance

Managing members within an active firm workspace includes real-time status toggling, permission updates, and safe offboarding:

\\mermaid

```
stateDiagram-v2
    [\] --> PendingInvite: Managing Partner sends invite
    PendingInvite --> Active: Associate clicks 'Accept Invitation'
    PendingInvite --> Declined: Associate clicks 'Reject'
    Active --> Deactivated: Admin toggles status to inactive
    Deactivated --> Active: Admin reactivates member
    Active --> Removed: Member leaves or is removed
    Removed --> [\]: Cases reassigned safely to Managing Partner
```

\\

### ### 7.1 Status Toggle Protocol (\Active\ ↔ \Pending Invite\ / \Deactivated)

The Managing Partner can temporarily pause a member's access (e.g., during leave or study sabbatical):

- In \LawFirmDashboardSection.jsx:

\\javascript

```
const toggleMemberStatus = (id) => {
  setTeamMembers(prev => prev.map(m => {
    if (m.id === id && !m.isOwner) {
      const nextStatus = m.status === 'Active' ? 'Pending Invite' : 'Active';
      toast.success(\Member status updated to ${nextStatus});
      return { ...m, status: nextStatus };
    }
    return m;
  }));
};
```

\\

### ### 7.2 Safe Member Removal & Case Preservation Protocol

Removing a lawyer from a firm must \\never\\ orphan active litigation dockets or delete court submissions.

When an administrator clicks \\\"Remove Member\\\":

1. \\Owner Protection Check:\\ The system strictly rejects attempts to remove the workspace owner (\if (target?.isOwner) return toast.error(\"Cannot remove workspace owner!\");).
2. \\Case Reassignment Protocol:\\ All cases where the departed member was set as \leadAdvocate\ or \leadAdvocateUserId\ are automatically reassigned to the Managing Partner or chosen successor:

\\javascript

// workspaceController.js (Lines 766-768)

```
await Project.updateMany(
  { workspaceId: workspace.\id, leadAdvocateUserId: membership.userId },
  { $set: { leadAdvocateUserId: targetUser.\id, leadAdvocate: targetUser.fullName || targetUser.name } }
```

);

\\

3. \\Seat Recapture:\\ The member's seat is immediately freed up (\\usedSeats\\ decreases by 1), allowing the firm to invite a replacement without incurring additional subscription costs.

## ## 8. Backend API Reference for Team Management

\\ Endpoint | Method | Parameters | Description |

\\:---|:---|:---|:---|

\\ /api/workspaces/:workspaceId/members\\ | \\GET\\ | \\workspaceId\\ in path | Fetches the complete list of team members with roles and statuses. |

\\ /api/workspaces/:workspaceId/invitations\\ | \\POST\\ | \\workspaceId\\ in path, payload in body | Dispatches an invitation to a new lawyer or staff member. |

\\ /api/workspaces/:workspaceId/members/:memberId/role\\ | \\PUT\\ | \\workspaceId\\, \\memberId\\, \\{ role, permission, modules }\\ | Updates a team member's role and permission configuration. |

\\ /api/workspaces/:workspaceId/members/:memberId/status\\ | \\PUT\\ | \\workspaceId\\, \\memberId\\, \\{ status }\\ | Sets member state to \\Active\\, \\Deactivated\\, or \\Suspended\\. |

\\ /api/workspaces/:workspaceId/members/:memberId/remove\\ | \\POST\\ | \\workspaceId\\, \\memberId\\, \\{ reassignToUserId }\\ | Permanently removes member from firm and reassigns all their cases. |

## ## 9. Security Best Practices & Compliance

- \\No Privilege Escalation:\\ Associates and Paralegals cannot elevate their own roles or invite other members.

- \\Audit Logging:\\ Every invitation sent, accepted, rejected, or revoked is recorded in \\WorkspaceActivity\\ with timestamp, acting user ID, and IP address.

- \\Instant Token Invalidation:\\ When a member is deactivated or removed, active session tokens for that firm workspace are instantly invalidated via backend token revocation middleware.